



# Mikoyan MiG-29

The Soviet MiG-29 was one of the most potent fighter-bombers of the 1980s and early 1990s. Jaw-droppingly agile and equipped with the world's best short-range missiles, tests proved that it was almost impossible to defeat in a low-speed dogfight. The aircraft was tough and cheap and spurned advanced electronics in favor of raw performance. More than 1,650 have been produced, serving with more than 40 air forces around the world.

**DESIGNED TO COUNTER** the American F-15 and F-16, the MiG-29 entered service in 1983 and replaced the MiG-23 as the main tactical fighter of the Soviet Air Force. The early MiG-29s lacked a fly-by-wire system—an electronic interface between pilot and flight controls—something all other agile fighters of its generation included. It was the first major fighter to feature a pilot's helmet that could be used to aim weapons,

making it almost invincible in a dogfight. The most surprising operator was the United States Air Force, which flew a top-secret training unit equipped with the MiG-29. Today an aircraft-carrier variant flies with the Indian Navy. The most advanced version of this aircraft is the MiG-35 (introduced in 2007), which can be fitted with thrust-vectoring control, making it the most maneuverable fighter in the world.

## SUPERB PERFORMANCE

The large leading-edge wing root extensions and under-slung engines both contribute to the aircraft's superb high alpha performance—the ability to control the aircraft when the nose is raised at large angles.



**Instrument landing system (ILS) aerial** communicates with ground control



**Tailplane** is all-moving

**Air intake louvers** on the upper wing feed air to the engine when on the ground to prevent debris from being ingested

**K-36 ejection seat** operates at any operational speed or altitude

**Infra-red search and track sensor** and laser ranger to track targets

**Faring** for integral landing system

**Radome** of fiberglass to protect antennae

**Ventral fin** on the starboard side

**B-8W rocket pods** can be fitted for the ground attack role

**Air intake** carries air to the engine when in flight